Gururaj J

Frontend Platform Engineer | Design Systems & Full-Stack
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Bengaluru, India | 60-day notice

Summary

Frontend platform engineer with 5 years of TypeScript and React, building web platforms for both humans and AI agents. At IBM, I own core components of the Carbon Design System, used by 5,000+ internal developers, with 190K+ weekly npm downloads. Outside work, I build and ship full-stack products on Cloudflare, including KnotCMS, a SaaS that won paying customers with zero ad spend.

Skills

- **Frontend**: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), React, Next.js, Angular, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS
- **Design Systems**: Component API design, Web Components (Lit), Storybook, accessibility (WCAG), theming, versioned migrations
- **Backend & Infrastructure**: Cloudflare Workers, D1, KV, Queues, R2, Hono, REST APIs, webhooks, OAuth, payments (Dodo Payments, Polar)
- **State & Data**: Redux Toolkit, Zustand, TanStack Query, Payload CMS
- **Testing & Tooling**: Jest, React Testing Library, Playwright, Jasmine, Karma, GitHub Actions, Monorepos, TurboRepo, pnpm, Vite, Amplitude, Segment

Experience

- **IBM India Pvt. Ltd. - India Software Labs** — Bengaluru, KA
  Frontend Developer, Carbon Design System — *February 2024 – Present*
  - **UI Platform**: Own 4 core components end to end across Carbon's React and Web Components libraries, used by 5,000+ developers internally, with @carbon/react at 190K+ weekly npm downloads.
  - **Platform Upgrades**: Shipped a major UI and platform upgrade adopted by 3,400+ implementations within two months. Landed 6 major upgrades with zero unplanned breaking changes, each with a written migration path.
  - **Agent-Readable Docs**: Built AI-agent support for the Carbon docs: any page is served as markdown through a .md URL suffix or Accept: text/markdown content negotiation. The site's content is also the main data source for the team's MCP search server.
  - **Search**: Built the docs search frontend end to end: server-rendered and URL-based for SEO and fewer client API calls, with keyword tracking through Amplitude and Segment.
  - **Launch Safety**: Owned the redirect strategy for the Oct 1 GA cutover. Verified about 400 legacy URLs with Playwright and set up the Cloudflare bulk-redirect workflow from CSV to production, with zero broken redirects at launch.
  - **Accessibility Automation**: Automated accessibility statuses for about 100 components, read directly from Playwright output in each Carbon package, removing nearly all manual CMS updates. Added edit restrictions and SSO gating for IBM-only data.
  - **Build Reliability**: Traced CI failures to a GitHub Actions cache keyed on the whole runner filesystem. Rescoped it to Next.js build inputs, cutting the step from over 2 minutes to under 30 seconds and failing PRs from about 80% to under 10%.
  - **Documentation Platform**: Architected a block-based content system and staged publishing in Payload CMS, so authors compose pages, ship rewrites alongside hotfixes, and roll back instantly, with no developer in the loop.
- **Wipro Limited | Client: Wells Fargo** — Bengaluru, KA
  Project Engineer, Cloud Migration and Modernization — *September 2021 – February 2024*
  - **Application Modernization**: Migrated 5 enterprise banking applications from WebForms to Angular 14-16, building a shared component library used across the migration, with lazy loading and code splitting to cut load times.
  - **Application Development**: Built responsive Angular and TypeScript apps against a microservices API layer, with Jasmine and Karma test coverage, accessibility compliance, and CI/CD pipeline work.

Projects

- **KnotCMS** knotcms.com
  Notion to Framer CMS sync SaaS, built and run solo *June 2026 – Present*
  - **Traction**: 3 paying customers from 20 signups, all organic through AEO and the Framer marketplace, with zero ad spend. Tracked activation (5 of 20 ran a real sync, 3 of those 5 paid) and held back feature work until usage justified it.
  - **Scaling Fix**: Load testing hit a Cloudflare Workers subrequest fan-out limit at 7,000 rows. Rebuilt the sync pipeline on Queues with batched invocations.
  - **Payments**: Integrated Dodo Payments and Polar for checkout, subscriptions and automated project provisioning, with webhook signature verification and per-customer rate limiting.
  - **Support-Free Recovery**: Fixed a stuck sync hit by the first paying customer, then added a webhook re-subscription flow so users recover from the same failure without contacting support.
  - **Merchant Dashboard**: Built onboarding and a self-service dashboard for provisioning, CMS field mapping and live sync monitoring, designed for non-technical Framer users.

Education

- **PES Institute of Technology and Management** Shivamogga, Karnataka
  Bachelor of Engineering; CGPA: 7.73 *Aug. 2017 – Aug. 2021*